GPSC CBRT · HOMOEOPATHIC PHYSICIAN · CORE

Topic 3: Homoeopathic Pharmacy

Complete notes with pictures, memory hooks, rapid revision and practice MCQs.

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Topic 3: Homoeopathic Pharmacy

How to use this guide

Pharmacy is one of the ten Core topics (the Core section carries 25 of the 60 CBRT marks), so expect about 2 to 3 questions. They ask a ratio, a percentage, a licence form, a year or an abbreviation, so this guide keeps the numbers in tables you can learn cold.

Syllabus heading	What it covers	Section
Sources, vehicles and drug collection	Vegetable, mineral, animal, nosodes, sarcodes, imponderabilia; liquid and solid vehicles	3.1
Scales and potentisation	Decimal, centesimal, LM; Hahnemannian and Korsakovian methods; trituration and succussion	3.2
Standards and legislation	Homoeopathic Pharmacopoeia of India; Drugs and Cosmetics Act and Rules	3.3
Prescription writing and dispensing	Parts of a prescription, abbreviations, posology, dosage forms	3.4

Standard books: Mandal and Mandal, *A Textbook of Homoeopathic Pharmacy*; *Homoeopathic Pharmacopoeia of India* (HPI); Hahnemann's *Organon* (§§264 to 271 for preparation); the Drugs and Cosmetics Act 1940 and Rules 1945.

Memory hook: pharmacy is a kitchen: **ingredients** (sources), **pots and water** (vehicles), **the recipe** (scales and potentisation), **the food inspector** (HPI and the Act) and **the menu card** (the prescription).

3.1 Sources, vehicles and drug collection

Sources of drugs

Kingdom	What is used	Examples
Vegetable	Whole plant or a part: root, bark, leaf, flower, seed, resin, juice	Aconite, Belladonna, Cinchona (bark), Nux vomica (seeds)
Mineral	Elements, salts, acids	Sulphur, Natrum mur, Calcarea carb, Nitric acid

Kingdom	What is used	Examples
Animal	Whole animal, venom or secretion	Apis (bee), Cantharis (beetle), Lachesis (snake venom), Sepia (ink)
Nosodes	Diseased tissue or products of disease	Psorinum, Medorrhinum, Tuberculinum
Sarcodes	Healthy animal tissue or secretion	Thyroidinum, Adrenalinum, Pepsinum
Imponderabilia	Energy with no matter	X-ray, Magnetis poli, Sol, Luna

Collecting plants

- Collect from the plant's **natural habitat**, wild where possible, healthy and free from disease.
- Collect in **dry, clear weather**, and use the plant fresh unless the monograph says dried.
- Collect each part when it is most active: **whole plants** usually as flowering begins; **seeds and fruits** when fully ripe.
- Identify the plant correctly by botanical name; the HPI monograph gives the part used and how to prepare it.

Vehicles

A **vehicle** is the inert medium that carries the drug. It must be pure, inert, and keep the drug stable.

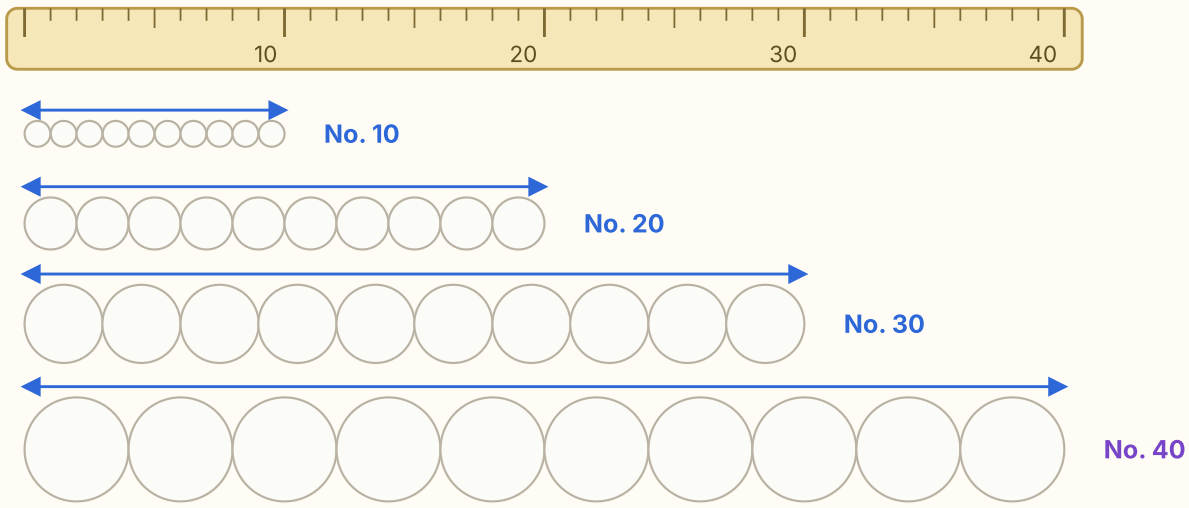
Vehicle	Key facts
Purified water	Used to dissolve water-soluble substances and to make some lower dilutions
Strong alcohol	95% v/v ethanol (limits about 94.7 to 95.2%); the usual base for dilutions
Absolute alcohol	At least 99.4% v/v
Dilute alcohol	Strong alcohol diluted with purified water; used for some mother tinctures
Dispensing alcohol	88% v/v; used to medicate globules
Glycerin	For glycerols and some external preparations
Sugar of milk (lactose)	Solid vehicle for triturations and tablets; about 1 g dissolves in 5 ml of cold water; insoluble in alcohol
Cane sugar globules	Sizes 5 to 80 (commonly 10 to 40); sizes 40 to 80 are called pilules; the size number is the length in mm of 10 globules in a row
Tablets	Lactose, about 1 grain (65 mg) each

Vehicle	Key facts
Cones	Cane sugar and egg; a No. 6 cone absorbs one drop of dispensing alcohol

Globule sizes: read the number

Cane-sugar globules on a millimetre ruler

The size number = the length, in mm, of 10 globules laid in a row



Sizes run 5 to 80 (commonly 10 to 40); 40 to 80 are called pilules.
Globules are cane sugar; they are medicated with 88% dispensing alcohol, then dried.
LM potencies use tiny poppy-seed globules: one drop medicates 500 of them.

Globule sizes · the number is the length in mm of 10 globules in a row

Memory hook: 95, 99.4, 88: "Strong is **95**, absolute **99.4**, the dispenser is **88**." Lactose dissolves in **water**, never in alcohol: so a 3C trituration is dissolved in water first, and alcohol is added after.

Preparing the neutral vehicles

A vehicle is **neutral**: medicinally inert, free from taste and smell, chemically stable, and able to carry the drug energy. Every vehicle is prepared and stored so that it stays pure.

Vehicle	How it is prepared and kept
Distilled water	Made by distillation; used fresh to dissolve triturations (the 3C conversion) and to make dilute alcohols; stored in clean, glass-stoppered bottles
Alcohol	Strong alcohol (95% v/v) is diluted with distilled water to the strength each step needs, for example dispensing alcohol (88%) for medicating globules

Vehicle	How it is prepared and kept
Sugar of milk	Pure, crystalline lactose, free from cane sugar and starch; ground to a fine powder and sieved before trituration; kept dry in closed containers
Globules, pilules, tablets	Globules and pilules are made of cane sugar; tablets are pressed from lactose; all are medicated only after they are made, by soaking in the potency in 88% alcohol and drying

Memory hook: water dissolves, alcohol preserves, lactose grinds, sugar carries. Neutral means it adds nothing of its own.

3.2 Scales and potentisation

Potentisation (dynamisation) is the step-by-step dilution of a drug with **succussion** (vigorous shaking) for liquids or **trituration** (grinding) for solids. Hahnemann describes it in Organon §§269 to 271; §270 gives the LM method.

The three scales

Scale	Ratio per step	Symbol	Introduced by	Note
Decimal	1 : 10	X or D	Constantine Hering	Mainly for low potencies and triturations
Centesimal	1 : 100	C or CH	Hahnemann	The standard scale; 1C = 2X in dilution
Fifty millesimal (LM, Q)	1 : 50,000	LM, 0/1, Q	Hahnemann, 6th edition	100 succussions per step; written 0/1, 0/2 and so on

Ten, hundred, fifty thousand: the three potency scales

Drug to vehicle at each step, who introduced it, and how it is written

Decimal · X

1 : 10

1 part drug + 9 parts vehicle
introduced by Hering
written 6X, 12X

Centesimal · C

1 : 100

1 part drug + 99 parts vehicle
Hahnemann's standard scale
written 30C, 200C, 1M

Fifty millesimal · LM

1 : 50,000

100 succussions per step
Organon 6th edition, §270
written 0/1, 0/2, 0/3

Insoluble drugs: three triturations, then conversion to liquid

Drug + lactose ground → **1C** one hour → **2C** one hour → **3C** one hour → **Dissolve** water first → **4C onwards** in alcohol

potency scales and trituration · 3 scales, 6 steps

Say the big numbers aloud, left to right: ten, hundred, fifty thousand. Then walk the bottom row: three hours of grinding before the drug ever meets alcohol.

The **mother tincture** (Ø) is the starting liquid preparation of a drug. **12C (24X)** is roughly where Avogadro's number is passed, so no molecule of the original substance is likely to remain.

Methods of making liquid potencies

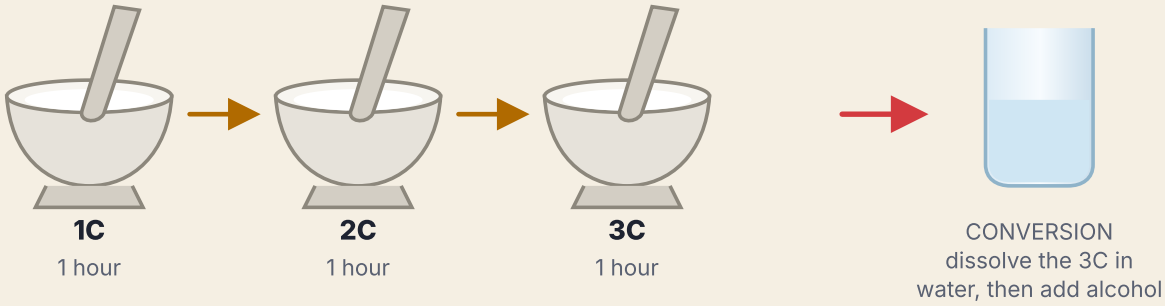
Method	How	Key point
Hahnemannian (multi-vial)	A fresh vial for every potency	The official method; most accurate
Korsakovian (single-vial)	The same vial is emptied and refilled for each step	Faster, less exact; marked K
Continuous fluxion	Fluid flows through a chamber with no separate steps	Used for very high potencies by machine

From drug to potency

Trituration for solids, succussion for liquids

Solids: TRITURATION with sugar of milk

for insoluble drugs: metals, most minerals, many animal products



each hour = 3 rounds of 20 minutes: grind, then scrape

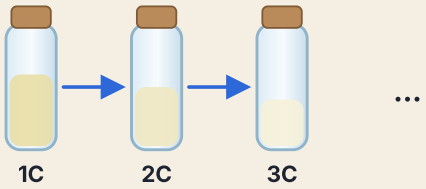
Liquids: DILUTION + SUCCUSSION (vigorous shaking)

centesimal step: 1 part of the previous potency + 99 parts of alcohol, then succussed



HAHNEMANNIAN (multi-vial)

a fresh vial for every potency · official, most accurate



KORSAKOVIAN (single-vial)

the same vial is emptied and refilled each step · faster, marked K



Ratio per step: X 1 : 10 (Hering) · C 1 : 100 (Hahnemann) · LM 1 : 50,000 (6th edition, 100 succussions).

From drug to potency · trituration for solids, succussion for liquids

Trituration

- Used for **insoluble** drugs (metals, most minerals, many animal products): the drug is ground with **sugar of milk**.
- Each potency takes **one hour**: three rounds of 20 minutes, each of grinding and scraping.
- Insoluble drugs are triturated to the 3C (6X); then the 3C is dissolved in water, alcohol is added, and the potency goes on as a liquid (**conversion**).

How LM potency is made (Organon §270)

1. Triturate the drug to the **3C**.
2. Dissolve 1 grain of the 3C in 500 drops of a water and alcohol mixture.
3. Take 1 drop of this, add 100 drops of alcohol and give **100 succussions**: this medicates poppy-seed-sized globules, **500 globules per drop**. That is LM 1 (0/1).
4. Dissolve 1 such globule in a drop of water, add 100 drops of alcohol, succuss 100 times: LM 2. And so on.

The ratio is 1/100 × 1/500 = **1 : 50,000** per step.

Memory hook: "**Ten, hundred, fifty thousand**": X is 10, C is 100, LM is 50,000. **Hering** brought the **X**; **Hahnemann** made **C** and **LM**. One **hour** per trituration, **three** triturations, then **convert**.

3.3 Standards and legislation

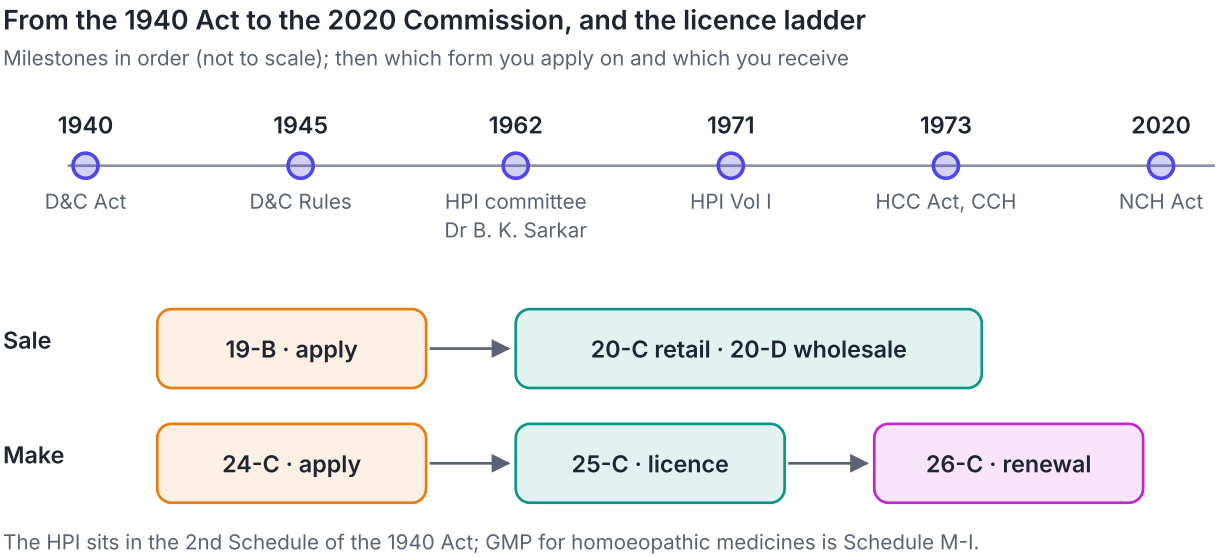
Homoeopathic Pharmacopoeia of India (HPI)

- A **pharmacopoeia** is the official book of standards for drugs: identity, purity, strength and method of preparation.
- The Government of India set up the **Homoeopathic Pharmacopoeia Committee in 1962**, under **Dr B. K. Sarkar**.
- **HPI Volume I** was published in **1971**; further volumes followed. Before it, Indian manufacturers followed the **HPUS** (USA) and the German pharmacopoeia.
- The HPI is listed in the **Second Schedule of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940**, which makes its standards legally binding.
- Most HPI mother tinctures are made by the **new method**, at a drug strength of about **1/10**; Hahnemann's older method sorted drugs into classes by their juice content.
- Drugs are tested at the **Pharmacopoeia Commission for Indian Medicine and Homoeopathy (PCIM&H), Ghaziabad**, which took over the Homoeopathic Pharmacopoeia Laboratory.

Drugs and Cosmetics Act 1940 and Rules 1945

Provision	What it covers
Rule 2(dd)	Defines homoeopathic medicines (the parenteral route is excluded)
Rule 30AA	Import of new homoeopathic medicines
Rules 67A, 67D, 67E, 67GG	Sale of homoeopathic medicines and the sale licence

Provision	What it covers
Form 19-B	Application for a licence to sell
Form 20-C / 20-D	Retail / wholesale sale licence (valid 5 years)
Form 24-C	Application for a licence to manufacture
Form 25-C	Licence to manufacture
Form 26-C	Certificate of renewal
Schedule M-I	Good manufacturing practice for homoeopathic medicines



pharmacy law timeline and licence forms

Orange boxes are what you apply on, green what you receive; renewal comes last.

Related councils

- **Central Council of Homoeopathy** (CCH) was set up under the **Homoeopathy Central Council Act, 1973**, to regulate education and practice.
- It was replaced by the **National Commission for Homoeopathy** (NCH) under the **NCH Act, 2020**.

Memory hook: "**62** formed, **71** printed": committee 1962, HPI Vol I 1971. Licence forms run like a ladder: **19-B** you ask to sell, **20-C/D** you sell, **24-C** you ask to make, **25-C** you make, **26-C** you renew.

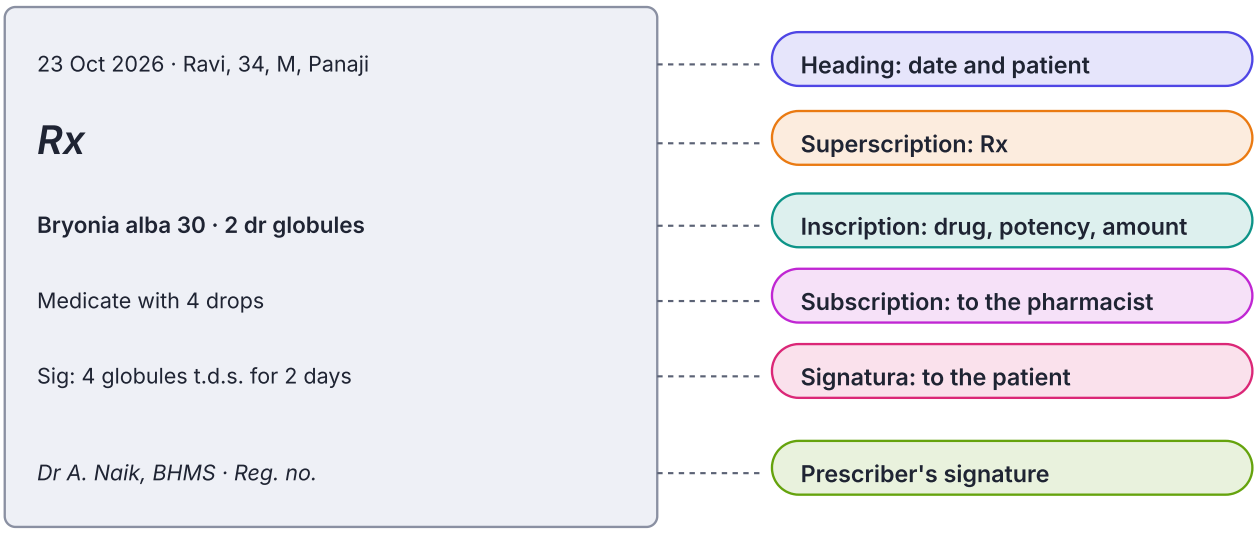
3.4 Prescription writing and dispensing

Parts of a prescription

1. **Heading:** date; the patient's name, age, sex and address; the prescriber's name, qualification and registration number.
2. **Superscription:** the symbol **Rx** ("take thou").
3. **Inscription:** the medicine, its potency and quantity, for example *Bryonia alba 30, 2 dram globules*.
4. **Subscription:** directions to the pharmacist (how to prepare or medicate).
5. **Signatura (signature):** directions to the patient, often marked **Sig.** or **S.**
6. **The prescriber's signature.**

A prescription reads top to bottom like a letter

An example slip on the left; the name of each part on the right



anatomy of a prescription · 6 parts

The two that get mixed up: **sub**scription is for the pharmacist, **sig**natura is for the patient.

Rules

- Write clearly and in full; one remedy at a time, as the Organon teaches (§273).
- Always state the **potency**, the **scale** and the **dose form**.
- Name the medicine by its full Latin name, not a vague abbreviation.
- Give the patient plain directions: when, how many, how long, and what to avoid (strong smells such as camphor or coffee, if the prescriber wishes).

Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
o.d. / b.d. / t.d.s. / q.i.d.	Once / twice / three times / four times a day
h.s.	At bedtime
s.o.s.	If needed
stat.	At once
a.c. / p.c.	Before food / after food
aq.	Water
gtt.	Drops
glob.	Globules
q.s.	Quantity sufficient
Ø	Mother tincture
S.L.	Saccharum lactis (sugar of milk, placebo)

Dosage forms

- **Internal:** mother tincture, dilutions, triturations, medicated globules (pilules), tablets, cones.
- **External:** ointments, lotions, glycerols, oils, liniments.
- **Medicating globules:** pour enough of the potency, made in **dispensing alcohol (88%)**, to soak all the globules in a clean vial; shake, then let them dry.
- **Storage:** amber glass, well corked, cool and dark, away from strong odours and direct sunlight.

Posology

- Posology is the science of dose: the potency, the quantity and the repetition.
- The **minimum dose** (Organon §§275 to 279) is the smallest dose that cures gently.
- Acute cases may need frequent repetition; chronic cases wait for the dose to act (see Topic 1, 1.3).

Memory hook: a prescription reads like a letter: **date and address**, "**Dear pharmacist**" (Rx), **what to send** (inscription), **how to pack it** (subscription), **how to use it** (signatura), **signed** by you.

Rapid revision

Cue	Fact
Strong alcohol	95% v/v
Absolute alcohol	At least 99.4% v/v
Dispensing alcohol	88% v/v; medicates globules
Sugar of milk	Lactose; soluble in water, insoluble in alcohol
Globule size	Length in mm of 10 globules in a row; 40 to 80 are pilules
Decimal scale	1:10, X; introduced by Hering
Centesimal scale	1:100, C; Hahnemann
LM scale	1:50,000; 100 succussions; Organon §270
Avogadro limit	About 12C (24X)
Trituration	Insoluble drugs with sugar of milk; one hour per potency; to 3C then converted
Hahnemannian method	Separate vial for each potency
Korsakovian method	One vial emptied and refilled
HPI	Committee 1962 (Dr B. K. Sarkar); Vol I 1971; in 2nd Schedule of the D&C Act
Testing laboratory	PCIM&H, Ghaziabad
Sale licence	Form 20-C retail, 20-D wholesale; applied for on 19-B
Manufacture licence	Form 25-C; applied for on 24-C
GMP	Schedule M-I
Superscription	Rx
Signatura	Directions to the patient
S.L.	Sugar of milk placebo

One-glance recall card

Topic 3 recall card: the 15 numbers asked most

Cover the small lines, say the fact from the big cue, then check

95% strong alcohol (v/v); absolute is at least 99.4%	**88%** dispensing alcohol: medicates globules	**Lactose** dissolves in water, not in alcohol
1 : 10 decimal scale, X; introduced by Hering	**1 : 100** centesimal scale, C; Hahnemann's standard	**1 : 50,000** LM scale, Organon §270; 100 succussions a step
12C = 24X Avogadro's number passed; no molecule likely left	**3C, 1 hour each** triturate insolubles to 3C, then dissolve in water	**Multi vs single** Hahnemannian: new vial; Korsakovian: same vial
1962 · 1971 HPI committee (B. K. Sarkar); HPI Vol I published	**2nd Schedule** HPI is in the 2nd Schedule of the D&C Act 1940	**19-B → 20-C/D** apply to sell, then retail or wholesale licence
24-C → 25-C apply to make, then the manufacture licence	**Schedule M-I** good manufacturing practice for homoeopathic medicines	**Sub vs Sig** subscription: pharmacist; signatura: patient

Topic 3 recall card · 15 tiles

For the last ten minutes before the exam: cover the small lines of each tile and say the fact from the big cue.

Practice MCQs

1. Strong alcohol as defined in the HPI contains about: (a) 88% v/v (b) 95% v/v (c) 99.4% v/v (d) 62% v/v
2. Dispensing alcohol used to medicate globules is: (a) 95% (b) 70% (c) 88% (d) 60%
3. Absolute alcohol contains not less than: (a) 95% (b) 98% (c) 99.4% (d) 100%
4. The drug-to-vehicle ratio of the decimal scale is: (a) 1:10 (b) 1:100 (c) 1:1000 (d) 1:50,000
5. The decimal scale was introduced by: (a) Hahnemann (b) Hering (c) Korsakoff (d) Kent
6. The 50 millesimal potency is described in the Organon in: (a) §128 (b) §153 (c) §270 (d) §273
7. Each LM potency step receives: (a) 10 succussions (b) 50 succussions (c) 100 succussions (d) 2 succussions
8. Insoluble substances are triturated up to: (a) 1C (b) 3C (c) 6C (d) 12C
9. Each trituration potency takes about: (a) 10 minutes (b) 30 minutes (c) one hour (d) three hours

10. The single-vial method of potentisation is the: (a) Hahnemannian (b) Korsakovian (c) fluxion (d) LM
11. Sugar of milk is: (a) soluble in alcohol (b) insoluble in water (c) soluble in water, insoluble in alcohol (d) insoluble in both
12. The Homoeopathic Pharmacopoeia Committee was formed in: (a) 1948 (b) 1962 (c) 1971 (d) 1973
13. HPI Volume I was published in: (a) 1962 (b) 1971 (c) 1973 (d) 1980
14. A retail sale licence for homoeopathic medicines is issued in Form: (a) 19-B (b) 20-C (c) 20-D (d) 25-C
15. A licence to manufacture homoeopathic medicines is issued in Form: (a) 24-C (b) 25-C (c) 26-C (d) 20-D
16. Good manufacturing practice for homoeopathic medicines is laid down in: (a) Schedule M (b) Schedule M-I (c) Schedule H (d) Schedule X
17. The part of a prescription giving directions to the patient is the: (a) superscription (b) inscription (c) subscription (d) signatura
18. In homoeopathic prescriptions, S.L. stands for: (a) sublingual (b) saccharum lactis (c) single liquid (d) solution
19. Globules of size 40 to 80 are called: (a) cones (b) pilules (c) tablets (d) granules
20. The potency beyond which no molecule of the original drug is likely to remain is about: (a) 3C (b) 6C (c) 12C (d) 30C

Answer key

Q	Answer	Why
1	b	95% v/v ethanol
2	c	88% v/v
3	c	At least 99.4% v/v
4	a	X = 1:10
5	b	Constantine Hering
6	c	§270, the LM method
7	c	100 succussions per step
8	b	Triturate to 3C, then convert
9	c	Three rounds of 20 minutes
10	b	Korsakovian: one vial

Q	Answer	Why
11	c	Lactose: water yes, alcohol no
12	b	1962, under Dr B. K. Sarkar
13	b	1971
14	b	20-C retail; 20-D wholesale
15	b	25-C; 24-C is the application
16	b	Schedule M-I
17	d	Signatura: directions to the patient
18	b	Sugar of milk, the placebo
19	b	Pilules
20	c	12C (24X): Avogadro's number passed